

The ThinkPad Line, Tier by Tier

A quick reference for spec'ing client fleets, ordered from the entry tier up to the flagship.
Laptops only.

VALUE 01 / 06

E Entry · SMB

The lowest level of ThinkPad, aimed at small and medium business rather than enterprise. Lowest build quality of the ThinkPads, though still better than most consumer-oriented laptops. Often more upgradeable than the premium lines.

SMB FOCUSGENERALLY NO VPRO

L Enterprise Value

The enterprise-focused value line. Much cheaper materials than the T series and often missing some of the premium features, which leads to cheaper pricing than the T.

BUDGET FLEETCHEAPER MATERIALS

MAINLINE 02 / 06

T The Mainline

The core business ThinkPad and the safe default for most users. Recent generations are built with repairability in mind, including a replaceable keyboard and a SODIMM slot.

DEFAULT PICKSERVICEABLE

T-s Premium Mainline

Slimmer and lighter than the T with even better materials, but it loses a lot of the upgradability and is not as easy to repair. Memory is soldered, so spec it correctly at purchase.

THIN & LIGHTSOLDERED RAM

MOBILE WORKSTATION 03 / 06

P-s Thin-and-Light Workstation — P14s, P16s

Essentially a T-s chassis with ISV certifications and optional professional GPUs. For users who need CAD or engineering software without carrying a full workstation.

ISV CERTIFIEDPRO GPU OPTIONT-S CHASSIS

COMPACT & PREMIUM-LITE 04 / 06

X13 Compact Premium

The compact premium option. Roughly T-s level quality in a smaller 13-inch chassis, for users who prioritize portability over screen size.

13-INCHT-S CLASS BUILD

X9 Premium-Lite

The newer premium-lite line. Design-focused with a cleaner look and fewer ports, sitting between the T-s and the X1 on price.

FEWER PORTSDESIGN-FORWARD

FLAGSHIP 05 / 06

X1C X1 Carbon

The flagship business line. Slimmest, lightest, all the bells and whistles, and among the most expensive of the non-workstation models.

EXECUTIVE TIERTIGHTEST

X1 2 X1 2-in-1

Formerly the X1 Yoga. The same premium tier as the X1 Carbon with a 360-degree hinge and pen support, often priced equal to or higher than the Carbon.

360° HINGEPEN SUPPORT

WINDING DOWN 06 / 06

Z Design-Forward AMD Premium

The design-forward AMD premium line. It has been winding down, so confirm current availability before recommending it to a client.

VERIFY AVAILABILITY

NOTE — Every ThinkPad P model is a laptop. Lenovo's desktop workstations are the separate ThinkStation brand. The full-size P16 is a heavy mobile workstation and is not covered here.

BEFORE QUOTING — The lineup shifts each generation. Confirm soldered versus socketed memory, vPro availability, and port selection on the specific model and generation before finalizing a quote.